## 11 April of AD 1510 to 31 March of AD 1510

a) News of the battle of Merv

Around six months passed at peace in Kābul. But a news sent by Mīrzā Khān (Wāis) in the month of Ramẓān (December) brought the turbulence. Ismā‘īl had defeated Shaybāni near Merv.[2] ‘It is not known,’ wrote the Mīrzā, ‘whether Shāhī Beg Khān has been killed or not. All the Aūzbegs have crossed the Amū. Amīr Aūrūs, who was in Qūndūz, has fled. About 20,000 Moghūls, who left the Aūzbeg at Merv, have come to Qūndūz. I have come there.’ ThenMīrzā Khān invited Bābur to join him in the quest to recover their ancestral territories.[†]

b) Bābur’s campaign in Transoxiana begins

The Mīrzā’s letter had travelled through passes blocked by snow. Babur took the one winter-route through Āb-dara going at the maximum speed he could, and kept the Ramẓān Feast in Bamiyan. He reached Qūndūz in Shawwāl (January of AD 1511).

The feast’s description by Ḥaidar seems likely to have been recorded because he had read Babur’s own remark, made in Ramzan (June of AD 1527).

c) Moghūl affairs

As mentioned by Mīrzā Khān in the letter, just outside Qūndūz stood the Moghūls who had come from Merv most likely as the reinforcement. They had served Babur’s uncles Mahmūd and Ahmad. When Shaybānī defeated the two Khāns at Akhsī in AD 1502 those Moghūlswere compelled by him to migrate into Khurāsān to places remote from Moghūlistān. Many among them had served in Kāshghar but had neverserved a Tīmūrid Mīrzā before. As Shaybāni died, they became free and came east. This was a Moghūl army without any Khān. They numbered to around 20,000 and were fully equipped with arms. On the other hand, Chaghatāīs were not more than 5,000. Along with Moghūls from Kābul they used the opportunity for making a return to a more amiable location with an able leadership. They saw in Qūndūz a legitimate Khāqān to lead them. The two branches of Moghūls were being led bySherīm Taghāī and Ayūb Begchīk.They proffered the Moghūl Khānship to Sa‘īd and at the same time proposed to set Babur aside.Perhaps they even conspired to kill him but same won’t happen given the way Babur dealt with the matter.

It’s unlikely that when they made their offer, they envisioned establishing themselves in the limited territory of Kābul. What they appeared to desire was what Babur granted them: Sa‘īd as their Khāqān and permission to travel north with him.